

Guided walkthroughs

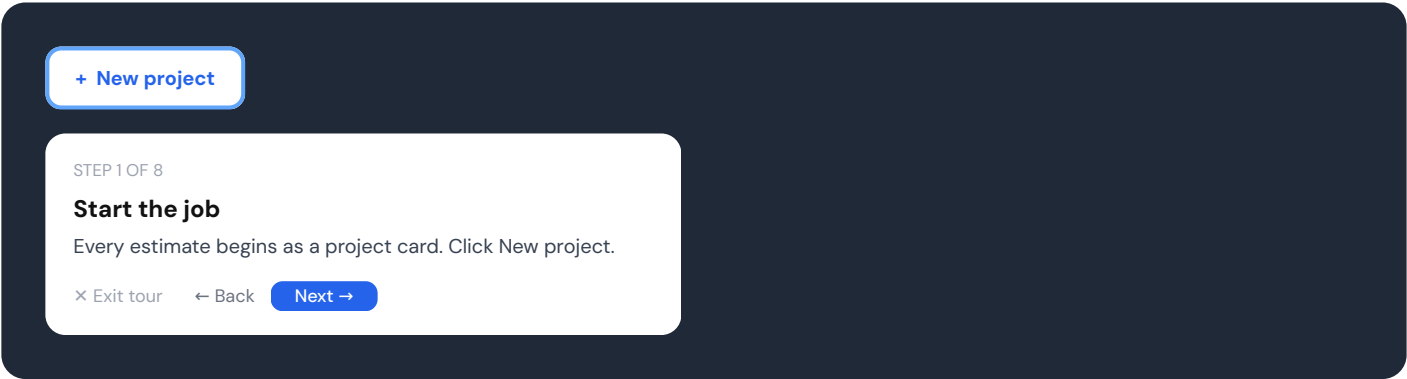
Build brief — how it looks, how it works · August 2026

The problem it solves: a new user opens MillSuite for the first time and doesn't know where anything is or what to do first. The fix is three layers: a short **setup wizard** (exists today), a **getting-set-up checklist**, and **opt-in guided tours** that highlight real buttons on the real screen.

The first hour, as the new owner experiences it

1. **Sign up → the wizard** (unchanged, 2 forced steps): shop rate + base cabinet labor. Five minutes.
2. **The dashboard shows a "Getting set up" checklist:** company info · logo · invoicing (QuickBooks or in-house) · first team member. Each item jumps to the right page and checks itself off. Dismissible, resumable — never forced.
3. **A modal offers the Welcome tour:** what it covers, "7 steps · about 2 minutes," Start or Not now. Not now = never nagged again; it waits in the Guides menu.
4. **Welcome tour** walks the nav: Sales, Projects, Manage, New project, Settings — and one idea step: "You estimate hours, your team tracks actual hours, and the system shows the difference — every job makes the next quote smarter." The learning loop, up front.
5. **Last step offers "Price my first job"** — chains into the second tour, optionally on a **practice project** they can delete after.

What a tour step looks like



The page dims, the real button glows, the popover says what it is and what to do. Progress is always visible. Esc quits anytime and remembers the step, so Resume picks up where they left off. Steps can cross pages — the tour navigates, waits for the screen to load, then continues.

The pieces under the hood

PIECE	WHAT IT IS
Tour engine	driver.js — a small open-source spotlight library, styled to MillSuite's fonts and colors. We write zero spotlight code.
Tours as data	Each tour is a list: element → title → two sentences. Scripts are drafted and approved in Cowork before Code builds them (specs/walkthroughs/v1-tours.md). Adding a tour later = writing a list.
Stable targets	Buttons get permanent data-tour name tags — tours can't break when styling changes.
Progress memory	Saved per user in the database: not started / step 3 of 8 / completed / dismissed. Managers and workers each have their own state.
Guides menu	Lives at Manage → Guides (NOT Settings — managers can't reach Settings). Every tour listed with description, step count, progress, Start/Resume/Restart. Future tours show as "coming soon."
Practice project	The first-job tour offers a sandbox: a project badged PRACTICE, excluded from reports and capacity so it never pollutes real numbers, one-click delete when done. Fumble-friendly.

Who sees what

ROLE	EXPERIENCE
Owner	Wizard → checklist → Welcome offer → full Guides menu.

Manager	No wizard, no checklist (that's owner setup). Full Guides menu at Manage → Guides, minus owner-only topics (billing setup). Never auto-nagged.
Worker	None of the above. A 3-step mini tour inside the time app on their phone: clock in, switch, request time off.

The catalog — three phases

PHASE	TOUR	NOTES
v1	Welcome · 7 steps	the map + the learning loop; offers itself once
v1	Price your first job · 8 steps	board → composer → estimate PDF; practice-project option
v2	Sell it · ~10 steps	kanban → sold → pre-pro approvals → production gates → the schedule
v2	Capacity calendar · ~6 steps	birdseye view, dragging, splitting months, outlook tie-in
v3	Rate book basics · ~8 + three deep-dives	dives: materials catalog · custom products · features (4–6 steps each)
v3	Change orders · ~7	from the CO one-sheeter
v3	Schedule · ~6 · Reports · ~5	
v3	Worker app · 3–4	lives inside /me, not Guides

The depth rule (the balance you asked about)

Core tours are capped at **8–10 steps and one main path** — short enough that nobody quits. Big topics get **4–6-step deep-dives** launched from the Guides page, and any popover can carry a "dig deeper →" link into the relevant dive. Nobody sits through a 25-step monster; nobody's left shallow if they want more. **The real gauge:** when the first customer onboards, watch where he stalls — that's where the next deep-dive belongs.

Build order

Session 1: engine + data-tour tags + progress storage + Guides page at Manage. **Session 2:** the two v1 tours + the Welcome offer + checklist. **Session 3:** practice-project mechanism. Then v2/v3 as each phase's scripts get drafted and approved in Cowork.

Scripts + full implementation contract: specs/walkthroughs/v1-tours.md · Build spec: STATE.md "Guided walkthroughs v1"